

ANIMALS & BIRDS · RECORDING

What the recorders hear at night.

Four acoustic recorders, one national research platform, and a library that's ours to open or lock away.

Four acoustic recorders sit across the property, two of them at the springs. They run day and night, picking up frogs, birds, and a good deal we haven't identified yet.

Everything they capture goes into a database. We call it the Eco Sounds register.

It runs on Ecosounds, the platform QUT's Ecoacoustics research group built for exactly this — recording, storing and analysing long stretches of environmental audio at a scale no person could sit and listen to in real time. QUT's own network extends the same idea across the whole continent: solar-powered recorders logging vocal wildlife nationally, because birds, frogs and insects are some of the most reliable indicators of how healthy a piece of Country actually is.

We're one node in that.

Not everything gets shared the same way. Some of what the recorders pick up will end up on the website — press play, hear the species. Some of it stays in the research archive, under our own consent terms, because it's ours before it's anyone else's data set.

The recorders aren't the only thing listening and watching. Flux towers elsewhere on the property carry their own cameras, photographing 500 metres of vegetation and flowering through the year, feeding into a separate national climate monitoring network. Different sensors, same principle — Country's been telling us what's happening all along. We're only just building the equipment to keep up.

Twelve months of recordings so far. Most of what's on them still hasn't been listened to properly.

Acoustic recording and data access via QUT Ecoacoustics (Ecosounds platform), Queensland University of Technology. Four recorders active on Turraburra, consent and access terms held by YACHATDAC.